

**LARQ raise \$10m**

Self-cleaning water bottle company LARQ has raised \$10M in Series A funding. <http://dgit.in/oct20-71>

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Elon Musk says will make Tesla batteries cheaper and more powerful in about three years. <http://dgit.in/oct20-72>

# Sennheiser CX 150BT Wireless

Good sound, but lacks some integral features

**T**he Sennheiser CX 150BT is a pair of mid-range wireless Bluetooth in-ear headphones that are priced just under 5K. Let's see if these earphones manage to impress us as thoroughly as Sennheiser's more premium offerings have.

## Build and comfort

The Sennheiser CX 150BT certainly boasts design accents and stylistic choices that are associated with Sennheiser products, but they're much more understated here. The earphones feature a glossy-black finish on the buds and a matte finish on the plastic modules. These are wireless in-ear headphones that can be worn in the neckband-style, albeit they're missing the part-stiff, part-flexible neckband.

The cables hang loose in this case, and the weight of the plastic modules often cause the buds to get tugged out of the ear. Oddly, one module is positioned in such a manner where it rests at the nape of your neck, while the other sits in the more traditional position, at the side of your neck. The unconventional placement caused the unit to feel wonky and unbalanced.

Nevertheless, the materials used are still pretty solid and robust. The three-button control system has tactile and responsive buttons, and the earbuds themselves are lightweight and ergonomic. The buds also create adequate amounts of seal, resulting in good passive isolation. Unfortunately though, the unit misses out on nifty magnetic modules that are usually present on wireless neckband earphones.

## Features

The Sennheiser CX 150BT Wireless earphones aren't exactly a feature-laden pair of wireless earphones, and they miss out on some integral features that are expected in the 5K price range. Let's start with the good. Powered by Bluetooth v5.0, the earphones feature



solid connectivity and wireless range. There's also support for the AAC and SBC codecs, however, the earphones do miss out on aptX codec support. The earphones also miss out on voice assistant support which is absurd in 2020.

The earphones also lack any sort of IP rating, so even though the earphones fit in the ear pretty snugly, we'd suggest that you steer clear of using these in the gym or while jogging/running.

The earphones, however, do have one redeeming feature which is the fantastic battery life. The company rates the battery life at a solid 10 hours and in our tests, at 60-70 percent volume, we were able to extract well over 10 hours worth of juice! You can easily go 2-3 days between charges even if you listen to music for a good 3-5 hours a day, which is impressive.

## Performance

The Sennheiser CX 150BT sports an A-shaped sound profile that shines when it comes to reproducing the mids. The bass response is not severely lacking. It's definitely got some punch and depth, without being overwhelming. However, if you're a bass-head, you might find the bass response to be a bit inadequate for your tastes.

Now, coming to the mids, the Sennheiser CX 150BT really soars here. Vocals, especially male ones, have ample amounts of clarity and sparkle. Female vocals can sound a tad tinny on higher volumes, but it's not too jarring.

The earphones seem to be best suited for vocal-centric and pop songs rather than rock and EDM. Nevertheless, they're not disappointing for those genres as well. Overall, these are one of the better sounding earphones you can purchase under 5K.

Coming to the microphone quality, we were impressed with the microphone's intelligibility. We tried dictating a paragraph in the notes app by voice and the app was able to pick up most words accurately. For calls, the microphone does a pretty decent job as well. The voice is clear and doesn't sound muffled or distant to the receiver.

## Bottomline

The Sennheiser CX 150BT is a great-sounding pair of wireless earphones under 5K that is marred by the absence of some integral features and some build flaws. If you don't mind the absence of voice assistant support and an IP rating, and if you deem the design to be good enough for you, there aren't too many wireless earphones in this price range that sound as good as the Sennheiser CX 150BT. However, if you're a basshead, you may have to look elsewhere to satiate your needs.

—Dhriti Datta

## SPECIFICATIONS

MICROPHONE: MEMS, omnidirectional | SOUND PRESSURE LEVEL (SPL): 110 dB (1 kHz/0 dB FS) | THD, TOTAL HARMONIC DISTORTION: 0.5 % (1 kHz, 100 dB SPL) | TRANSDUCER PRINCIPLE: Dynamic | WEIGHT: 13 g | USB STANDARD: Type C | BATTERY TIME: 10 h | BLUETOOTH VERSION: 5.0 | CODECS: SBC, AAC | IMPEDANCE: 28 Ω

## CONTACT

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